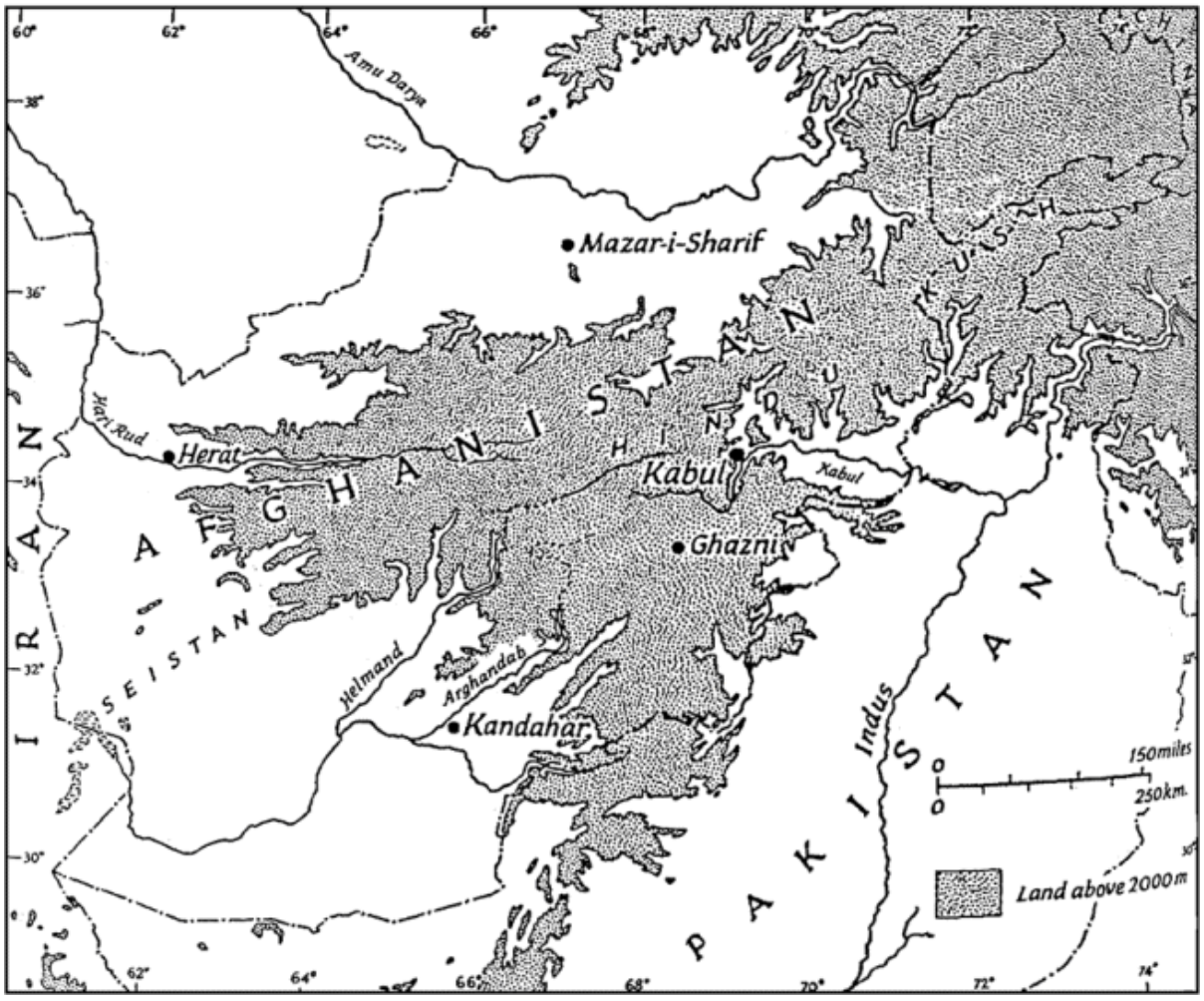
The province where Kandahar stood came to be known as Arachosia and was considered an important political prize, having been fought over by a loyalist of Darius I of Persia against a rebel pretender to the Achaemenid throne.[7] Later it was overrun by Alexander in 330 BCE, a consequence of his defeating Darius III in 331 BCE. The Macedonian conqueror, now the ruler of the satrapies of the Achaemenids, placed new administrators in position to hold his conquests.[8] He is known to have appointed a Greek governor at Arachosia who was provided with a military arm consisting of some 4000 infantry and 600 horsemen. Kandahar, rechristened Alexandropolis, remained the capital of the province.



Map 3: Afghanistan in relation to Iran and Pakistan